

July 22, 2024

Andrew S. Johnston
Executive Secretary
Maryland Public Service Commission
William Donald Schaefer Tower
6 St. Paul Street, 16th Floor
Baltimore, Maryland 21202

Re: Case No. 9478; Comments of Vehicle-Grid Integration Council on BGE's Smart Charge Management Program Proposal

Dear Mr. Johnston,

The Vehicle-Grid Integration Council ("VGIC")¹ respectfully provides its comments in response to Baltimore Gas and Electric's ("BGE" or "the Company") Smart Charge Management Program Proposal to the Maryland Public Service Commission ("Commission") in Case No. 9478.

I. Introduction

VGIC is a 501(c)(6) membership-based advocacy group committed to advancing the role of electric vehicles ("EVs") and vehicle-grid integration ("VGI") through policy development, education, outreach, and research. VGIC supports the transition to decarbonized transportation and electric sectors by ensuring the value from EV deployments and flexible EV charging and discharging is recognized and compensated to achieve a more reliable, affordable, and efficient electric grid.

II. Comments

VGIC appreciates BGE's work on advancing managed charging. BGE has been a leader in making the transition to electric vehicles affordable, reliable, and clean. The Company was among the first utilities in the country to utilize new rates to encourage charging off-peak, and they continue to leverage technologies to further enhance the integration of electric vehicles onto the grid—including utilizing alternative technologies to support time-of-use rates, piloting active managed charging at significant scale with a focus on distribution optimization and pursuing partnerships to vehicle-to-everything ("V2X") bidirectional charging solutions. As a national

¹ VGIC member companies and supporters include American Honda Motor Co., Inc., BorgWarner, Fermata Energy, Ford Motor Company, General Motors, Nissan Group of North America, Bidirectional Energy, Customized Energy Solutions, dcbe, Eaton Corporation, Emporia Corp., EnergyHub, EV.Energy, Flux, Inc., FreeWire Technologies, Inc., GridBeyond, GridWiz, Kaluza, Landis + Gyr, Leapfrog Power, Inc., Nuvve Holding Corporation, Orange Charger, Peak Power, PowerFlex, Qcells, Stellantis N.V., Sumitomo Electric, The Mobility House, Toyota Motor North America, Inc., WeaveGrid, Clean Power Alliance, Hoosier Energy, Peninsula Clean Energy, and Sacramento Municipal Utility District. The views expressed in these Comments are those of VGIC, and do not necessarily reflect the views of all individual VGIC member companies or supporters. (<https://www.vgicouncil.org/>)

trade group, we often point to successes in Maryland and at BGE on electric vehicle-grid integration as leading examples for other state commissions and utilities to follow.

BGE proposes expanding the Company's residential offering and points to the continued stakeholder support for Smart Charge Management ("SCM"). BGE has requested that the Commission consider the Company's request to expand its SCM offering in advance of the Commission's consideration of the Company's Phase II EV proposal to ensure that the SCM program continues seamlessly without customer interruption. The expansion will provide customers with more choices in technology and enable BGE to expand SCM to maintain "the strong program track record, ensure continuity and positive customer experience, and grid benefits that would support the EV transition."² Many parties have expressed support for the SCM work, to date, including Commission Staff, Maryland Office of People Counsel, ev.energy, and Alliance for Transportation Electrification. VGIC expressed support in our comments on the Phase 1 programs and is reiterating our support here for both the SCM demonstration work and BGE's proposed expansion.

With this expansion proposal, BGE aims to support Maryland's policy goals. BGE's efforts to advance EVs and decarbonize the transportation and electricity sectors are aligned with Maryland's Advanced Clean Cars II policy, the Maryland Climate Solutions Now Act of 2022, and the Distributed Renewable Integration and Vehicle Electrification (DRIVE) Act.

BGE's proposal also highlights the benefits of SCM for customers and the grid. In BGE's filing, the Company points to a cost-effectiveness test result of 1.58 under the Maryland jurisdiction-specific benefit-cost test. This benefit-cost analysis highlights that BGE's managed charging offering is cost-effective. The program increases the affordability of EV charging, recognizing that the benefits of VGI "include wholesale energy cost savings, capacity cost savings, marginal T&D cost savings, reduction in transmission and distribution losses, and positive grid reinforcement (deferral of additional distribution system buildout)."³

VGIC believes that BGE's request is reasonable. The Company proposes expanding a successful and cost-effective pilot that has captured a wide range of benefits, making EV charging more affordable by shifting energy to low-cost times, reducing charging during the system peak, and lowering the level of non-coincident peaks that impact the distribution system. We also commend BGE's proposal to scale up the program in terms of participation and note that there are other utilities with similar targets. For instance, Con Edison in New York already had 12,260 customers participating in its managed charging program at the end of 2023⁴ and Xcel Energy Colorado administers a managed charging program approved by the Colorado Public Utilities Commission to target more than 40,000 customers by the end of 2026.⁵

² BGE. June 24, 2024. Smart Charge Management Program Proposal. Case No. 9478

³ BGE. June 24, 2024. Smart Charge Management Program Proposal. Case No. 9478

⁴ Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc.. January 30, 2024. Managed Charging Implementation Plan. Case 18-E-0138. Page 26.

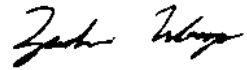
⁵ Public Service Company of Colorado (Xcel Energy). Attachment HS-1. 2024-2026 Transportation Electrification Plan. Proceeding Number 23A-0242E. Page

As discussed in our comments on the Phase 1 review, we are fortunate that, as an industry, few pilots or programs have had a temporary discontinuance. Still, we are aware of the negative impacts of starting and stopping programs that have affected other customer program areas. VGIC respectfully advises against interrupting the significant progress made in the VGI space. We urge the Commission to enable BGE to continue to serve existing customers while also opening new enrollments in this important EV program offering and avoiding any scenario where cost-effective programs are suspended.

VGIC strongly recommends that the Commission approve BGE's expansion proposal. Keeping the program going is important for ensuring customer continuity and expanding access to a cost-effective VGI program. Expanding the SCM program will lead to greater benefits, supporting large scale EV adoption and reducing impacts to the grid and ratepayers.

III. Conclusion

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to provide comments and looks forward to further collaboration with stakeholders on this important initiative,



Zach Woogen
Interim Executive Director
Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (VGIC)
vgicregulatory@vgicouncil.org
(510) 665-7811